Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

Leaving Certificate 2024
Deferred Examinations

Marking Scheme

English

Ordinary Level

Note to teachers and students on the marking schemes for the deferred examinations

Marking schemes published by the State Examinations Commission are not intended to be standalone documents. They are an essential resource for examiners who receive training in the correct interpretation and application of the scheme. However, it should be noted that the marking schemes for the deferred examinations may not necessarily be as detailed as the corresponding marking schemes for the main sitting of an examination, which serve to ensure consistency across a large team of examiners.

Marking schemes are working documents. While a draft marking scheme is prepared in advance of the examination, the scheme is not finalised until examiners have applied it to candidates' work and the feedback from examiners has been collated and considered in light of the full range of responses of candidates, the overall level of difficulty of the examination, and the need to maintain consistency in standards between the main sitting and the deferred sitting and from year to year. In the case of the deferred examinations, this means that the level of detail may vary by question, as the marking scheme will only have been finalised for the questions attempted by the candidates who sat these examinations.

In the case of marking schemes that include model solutions or answers, it should be noted that these are not intended to be exhaustive. Variations and alternatives may also be acceptable. Examiners must consider all answers on their merits, and will have consulted with a senior examiner when in doubt.

Future Marking Schemes

Assumptions about future marking schemes on the basis of past schemes (whether for the main examinations or the deferred examinations) should be avoided. While the underlying assessment principles remain the same, the details of the marking of a particular type of question may change in the context of the contribution of that question to the overall examination concerned. Accordingly, aspects of the structure, detail and application of the marking scheme for a particular examination will not necessarily be the same for the deferred sitting as for the main sitting or from one year to the next.

CRITERIA FOR ASSESSMENT.

The tasks set for candidates in both Paper 1 and Paper 2 will be assessed in accordance with the following criteria:

- Clarity of Purpose **(P)** 30% of the marks available for the task
- Coherence of Delivery **(C)** 30% of the marks available for the task
- Efficiency of Language use **(L)** 30% of the marks available for the task
- Accuracy of Mechanics **(M)** 10% of the marks available for the task

Each answer will be in the form of a response to a specific task, requiring candidates to:

- display a clear and purposeful engagement with the set task
- sustain the response in an appropriate manner over the entire answer
- manage and control language appropriate to the task
- display levels of accuracy in spelling and grammar appropriate to the required/chosen register.

Schematised detail regarding these criteria is to be found in Appendix 1 of this Marking Scheme. The Grade Grid utilised for purposes of applying the Criteria for Assessment throughout the marking is to be found in Appendix 2 of the Marking Scheme.

Where discrete criteria awarding is in operation, marks will be indicated on candidates' scripts in all instances in the order in which they are set out above. Thus, Clarity of **P**urpose will always appear first in the list of marks. Marks awarded for **C**oherence of Delivery will follow and so on to the end. Marks for Accuracy of **M**echanics can still be awarded in line with the candidate's proficiency in this area.

Given the primacy of Clarity of Purpose (P), marks awarded for either Coherence of Delivery (C) or Efficiency of Language Use (L) cannot exceed the marks awarded for Clarity of Purpose.

Candidates' work is marked using the Criteria for Assessment. The indicative material included in the marking scheme is provided to aid examiners and is intended to broadly indicate the type of responses candidates might offer. The indicative material is not exhaustive and all appropriate valid answers should be marked according to their merits, using the Criteria for Assessment.

The list of texts prescribed for assessment in 2024 is set out in the appropriate DES Circular **0013/2022**

Use of Codes

To assist with forming a judgement it will be helpful to place an accurate tick at the points identified in the answer.

Use the full range of marks available

Examiners should make themselves familiar with the range of marks available for each of the tasks set and utilise the full range of marks as appropriate in the course of the marking.

Assessment will proceed in accordance with the State Examinations Commission booklet, *Instructions for Examiners.*

General – Paper 1

"This paper will be specifically aimed at testing the comprehending and composing abilities of students." (DES English Syllabus, 7.3, p19).

MISREADING OF INSTRUCTIONS RELATING TO QUESTION CHOICE – PAPER I

CANDIDATE ANSWERS MORE THAN THE REQUIRED NUMBER OF QUESTIONS IN SECTION I

- Mark all attempts out of full marks.
- The lower mark/s will automatically be disallowed.

CANDIDATE ANSWERS MORE THAN THE REQUIRED NUMBER OF QUESTIONS IN SECTION 2

- Mark all attempts out of full marks.
- The lower mark/s will automatically be disallowed.

PAPER 1

SECTION I COMPREHENDING (100 marks)

N.B. Answer ONLY ONE Question A and ONLY ONE Question B.

TEXT I – A SUCCESSFUL SINGER-SONGWRITER

Question A – 50 marks

(i) Identify three aspects of Taylor Swift's personality, evident in TEXT 1, that in your opinion may have helped her to become successful. Explain why you think these aspects of Taylor's personality may have contributed to her success. (15)

Candidates should identify three aspects of Taylor Swift's personality, evident in TEXT 1, that in their opinion may have helped her to become successful. They should explain why they think these aspects of Taylor's personality may have contributed to her success. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Aspects of Taylor Swifts' personality, evident in TEXT 1, that in their opinion may have helped her to become successful include: her capacity for hard work; her creativity – she has made music in a variety of genres; she is articulate; has a sense of humour; her enthusiasm for her work/career; her resilience, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(ii) Explain what Taylor Swift says to encourage the graduating students during the course of her speech. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)

Candidates should explain what Taylor Swift says to encourage the graduating students during the course of her speech. Responses should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Taylor Swift encourages the graduating students by telling them: they will get to chart their own path; by pointing out the independence and freedom to make their own decisions that they will gain on graduation; by explaining that they will learn from their mistakes; by assuring them that they will recover from the hard things that happen to them; by predicting they will become more resilient; by sharing her own experiences, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(iii) (a) You have been asked to choose a title for a documentary film about Taylor Swift. Based on what you have read above, which one of the following titles would you choose?

Swift Success Taylor Made Taylor Swift – A life in Music

Support your choice with reference to the text. (10)

Candidates should choose a title for a documentary film about Taylor Swift from the choice presented. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Candidates must select one title from the list but may refer to the others in their response. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	P+C = 6	L + M = 4

(b) Identify a successful person you would really like to meet. Explain at least one reason why you would particularly like to meet this person. In your answer you may not refer to any of the people featured in this examination paper. (10)

Candidates should identify a successful person they would really like to meet and explain at least one reason why they would particularly like to meet this person. Allow for a broad interpretation of a "successful" person. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	P+C = 6	L + M = 4

Question B – 50 marks

Based on your reading of TEXT 1, imagine you are one of the graduates who attended the ceremony at which Taylor Swift spoke. Write a post for your blog in which you: outline what Taylor Swift told the graduating students, give your reaction to what she said and explain why you do or do not think she was a good choice of speaker for the event.

Candidates should imagine they are one of the graduates who attended the ceremony at which Taylor Swift spoke and write a post for their blog in which they: outline what Taylor Swift told the graduating students, give their reaction to what she said and explain why they do or do not think she was a good choice of speaker for the event. Candidates should deal with all aspects of the task, although not necessarily equally. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Discrete Criteria ex 50	P = 15	C = 15	L = 15	M = 5

50 marks	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
	50 - 45	44 - 40	39 - 35	34 - 30	29 - 25	24 - 20	19 - 15	14 - 0

TEXT 2 – A SUCCESSFUL ACTOR

Question A – 50 marks

(i) Identify three aspects of Mark Smith's personality, evident in TEXT 2, that in your opinion may have helped him to become successful. Explain why you think these aspects of Mark's personality may have contributed to his success. (15)

Candidates should identify three aspects of Mark Smith's personality, evident in TEXT 2, that in their opinion may have helped him to become successful and explain why they think these aspects of Mark's personality may have contributed to his success. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Aspects of Mark Smith's personality that may have helped him to become successful include: his talent; his capacity for hard work; his creativity; his bravery; his "star quality"; his intelligence; his ambition; his resilience, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(ii) Explain the ways in which Aisling Byrne contributed to Mark Smith's success. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)

Candidates should explain the ways in which Aisling Byrne contributed to Mark Smith's success. Expect candidates to give more than one reason in their response. Responses should be with reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Ways in which Aisling Byrne contributed to Mark Smith's success include: By casting him in plays; by collaborating with him in writing a play about his life story, by being ambitious for him; by "pushing him to do fantastic things"; by "keeping her ear to the ground" for opportunities for Mar; by encouraging him; by appreciating his talent, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(iii) (a) You have been asked to choose a title for a documentary film about Mark Smith's life. Based on what you have read above, which one of the following titles would you choose?

Believe It, Achieve It Making A Mark A Man of Many Talents

Support your choice with reference to the text. (10)

Candidates should choose a title for a documentary film about Mark Smith from the choice presented. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Candidates must select one title from the list but may refer to the others in their response. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	**P + C = 6**	**L + M = 4**

(b) Identify a successful person you would really like to meet. Explain at least one reason why you would particularly like to meet this person. In your answer you may not refer to any of the people featured in this examination paper. (10)

Candidates should identify a successful person they would really like to meet and explain at least one reason why they would particularly like to meet this person. Allow for a broad interpretation of a "successful" person. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	P + C = 6	L + M = 4

Question B – 50 marks

You have been asked to write a letter to Mark Smith inviting him to present their school's High Achiever Award. This award recognises achievement in sport or academics or the arts. It can also be awarded for community involvement. In your letter you should: invite Mark Smith to the event, provide him with information and details about the event, identify the winner and explain the reasons why this person is being honoured in this way.

Candidates should write the text of a letter they would send to Mark Smith inviting him to present your school's High Achiever Award, as described above. In the letter candidates should: invite Mark Smith to the event, provide him with information and details about the event, identify the winner and explain the reasons why this person is being honoured in this way. The register may be formal or semi-formal. All aspects of the task should be dealt with, although not necessarily equally. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria of Assessment.

Discrete Criteria ex 50	P = 15	C = 15	L = 15	M = 5

50 marks	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
	50 - 45	44 - 40	39 - 35	34 - 30	29 - 25	24 - 20	19 - 15	14 - 0

TEXT 3 – A SUCCESSFUL SPORTSPERSON

Question A – 50 marks

(i) Identify three aspects of Kellie Harrington's personality, evident in TEXT 3, that in your opinion may have helped her to become successful. Explain why you think these aspects of Kellie's personality may have contributed to her success. (15)

Candidates should identify three aspects of Kellie Harrington's personality, evident in TEXT 3, that in their opinion may have helped her to become successful and explain why they think these aspects of Kellie's personality may have contributed to her success. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Aspects of Kellie Harrington's personality that may have helped her to become successful include: her determination; her persistence; her bravery/fearlessness; her resilience; her capacity for hard-work; her passion for her sport, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(ii) Explain the ways in which Joey O'Brien contributed to Kellie Harrington's success. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)

Candidates should explain the ways in which Joey O'Brien contributed to Kellie Harrington's success. Responses should be with reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Indicative material: Ways in which Joey O'Brien contributed to Kellie Harrington's success include: convincing others to allow girls join the boxing club; inviting Kellie in to do fitness and boxing classes; showing her boxing techniques; went to her house to let her know she was allowed join; showed a personal interest, etc.

Combined Criteria ex 15	**P + C = 9**	**L + M = 6**

(iii) (a) You have been asked to choose a title for a documentary film about Kellie Harrington. Based on what you have read above, which one of the following titles would you choose?

Fighter Girl Never Give Up Champ

Support your choice with reference to the text. (10)

Candidates should choose a title for a documentary film about Kellie Harrington from the choice presented. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Candidates must select one title from the list but may refer to the others in their response. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	**P+C = 6**	**L + M = 4**

(b) Identify a successful person you would really like to meet. Explain at least one reason why you would particularly like to meet this person. In your answer you may not refer to any of the people featured in this examination paper. (10)

Candidates should identify a successful person they would really like to meet and explain at least one reason why they would particularly like to meet this person. Allow for a broad interpretation of a "successful" person. Reward all valid responses on their merits, giving consideration to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Combined Criteria ex 10	P+C = 6	L + M = 4

Question B – 50 marks

Imagine you have written a book about the life of a successful person you admire. Identify the successful person your book is about and write an introduction for it in which you: explain why you chose to write about this person, outline what writing the book taught you about success and share the reasons why you think readers will enjoy the book.

Candidates should imagine they have written a book about the life of a successful person they admire. They should identify the successful person their book is about and write an introduction for it in which they: explain why they chose to write about this person, outline what writing the book taught them about success and share the reasons why they think readers will enjoy the book. All aspects of the task should be dealt with, although not necessarily equally. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response.

Discrete Criteria ex 50	P = 15	C = 15	L = 15	M = 5

50 marks	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
	50 - 45	44 - 40	39 - 35	34 - 30	29 - 25	24 - 20	19 - 15	14 - 0

SECTION II COMPOSING (100 marks)

General

The composition assignments (in **bold print** below) are intended to reflect language study in the areas of information, argument, persuasion, narration and the aesthetic use of language.

N.B. "The general functions of language outlined here will continually mix and mingle within texts. So there can be an aesthetic argument, a persuasive narrative or an informative play." (DES English Syllabus 2.5).

The composition titles refer back to individual texts. However, the examination paper itself is constructed around a single theme and all the texts on the paper are considered to be a resource for the candidates. Therefore, even though a composition title is linked to one of the texts, in shaping their compositions candidates are free to refer to, quote from, or draw ideas from any or all of the texts and their accompanying illustrations.

Candidates may refer formally to the text to which the composition is linked or they may complete the composition assignment with reference to their own store of knowledge/reference/experience.

Candidates should undertake one of the seven composition assignments that appear in bold print on the examination paper.

Composing 2

2. TEXTS 1, 2 and 3, all deal with the theme of Celebrating Success.

As the chairperson of your school's graduation committee, you have been asked to give a speech at the graduation event. The theme of your speech is, "Celebrating Success". Write the speech you would deliver.

Candidates should imagine they are the chairperson of their school's graduation committee and write a speech on the theme of "Celebrating Success", to be delivered at the graduation event. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the composition with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

P: Focus – **a speech** on the theme of "Celebrating Success", to be delivered at a school's graduation event
Understanding of genre - tone and register may be formal or informal but should show an awareness of the intended audience; the speech may include examples/
anecdotes/quotations, etc; use inclusive/rhetorical language, etc.
Relevance
Originality and freshness, etc.

C: The extent to which the speech is successfully sustained and developed
effective shaping of the speech; sequencing and management of ideas, etc

L: Quality and control of language e.g. style, clarity, vocabulary, syntax, punctuation, etc.

M: Accuracy of mechanics **Etc.**

	01	**02**	**03**	**04**	**05**	**06**	**07**	**08**
100%	100 - 90	89 - 80	79 - 70	69 - 60	59 - 50	49 - 40	39 - 30	29 - 0
30%	30 - 27	24	21	18	15	12	9	8 - 0
10%	10 - 9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2 - 0

Composing 5

5. The individuals featured in TEXTS 1, 2 and 3 are all passionate about what they do in life.

Write a personal essay about an activity you feel passionate about, explain how participating in this activity makes you feel and the impact your participation has had on your life.

Candidates should write a personal essay about an activity they feel passionate about, explain how participating in this activity makes them feel and the impact their participation has had on their lives. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the composition with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

P: Focus - **a personal essay** about an activity they feel passionate about, explain how participating in this activity makes them feel and the impact their participation has had on their lives
Understanding of genre – the writing should be shaped as a personal essay
e.g. written from the perspective of the engaged 'I'/personal register/written in the first person/reflective insights/confessional tone/individual observation/use of personal anecdotes/include pertinent personal details/strongly held personal views and opinions/use of authentic personal voice, etc.
Relevance
Originality and freshness, **etc.**
C: The extent to which the essay is successfully shaped, sustained and developed, sequencing and management of ideas, etc.
L: Quality and control of language e.g. style, vocabulary, syntax, punctuation, etc.
M: Accuracy of mechanics **Etc.**

	01	**02**	**03**	**04**	**05**	**06**	**07**	**08**
100%	100 - 90	89 - 80	79 - 70	69 - 60	59 - 50	49 - 40	39 - 30	29 - 0
30%	30 - 27	24	21	18	15	12	9	8 - 0
10%	10 - 9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2 - 0

Composing 7

7. In TEXTS 1, 2 and 3 we meet people who have enjoyed different kinds of success.

Write a personal essay about what success means to you, discuss some of your personal successes and explain who or what helped you to achieve your success.

Candidates should write a personal essay about what success means to them, discuss some of their personal successes and explain who or what helped them to achieve their success. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the composition with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

Mark ex 100 by reference to the criteria for assessment.

P: Focus – **a personal essay,** about what success means to them, discuss some of their personal successes and explain who or what helped them to achieve their success
Understanding of genre – the writing should be shaped as a personal essay e.g. written from the perspective of the engaged 'I'/personal register/written in the first person/reflective insights/confessional tone/individual observation/use of personal anecdotes/include pertinent personal details/strongly held personal views and opinions/use of authentic personal voice, etc.
Relevance
Originality and freshness, etc.
C: The extent to which the essay is successfully shaped, sustained and developed.
sequencing and management of ideas, etc.
L: Quality and control of language e.g. style, vocabulary, syntax, punctuation, etc.
M: Accuracy of mechanics **Etc.**

	01	**02**	**03**	**04**	**05**	**06**	**07**	**08**
100%	100 - 90	89 - 80	79 - 70	69 - 60	59 - 50	49 - 40	39 - 30	29 - 0
30%	30 - 27	24	21	18	15	12	9	8 - 0
10%	10 - 9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2 - 0